ERES-CRYPTO-STD-2026-001

ERES Crypto Standard — Full Stack Specification

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Status of This Document

This is a Standards Track draft of the ERES Crypto Standard (hereafter **ECS**). It has been produced through the Multi-Instance Ensemble Validation Method (MIEVM), drawing on three independent drafts from the canonical MIEVM ensemble (Claude as epistemic developer, DeepSeek as cryptographic generator, ChatGPT as adversarial-standards reviewer). Where the drafts diverged, this document preserves the strongest defensible form of each contribution and discards claims that cannot be independently verified.

This document is submitted for MIEVM adversarial re-review, Hague-equivalent governance review, and open public commentary under CCAL v2.1.

Abstract

The ERES Crypto Standard (ECS) defines a **semantic-attestation and authorization protocol layer** that sits above conventional cryptographic infrastructure. ECS does not replace encryption, digital signatures, transport security, or computational-hardness-based cryptographic primitives. Instead, it composes with them to produce a deterministic, auditable, multi-dimensional authorization decision from three independent classes of evidence:

1. **CBGMODD** — governance role attestations (a structured seven-role civic vector)
2. **FAVORS** — biometric evidence bundle (six channels: Fingerprint · Aura · Voice · Odor · Retina · Signature)
3. **BERA** — Bio-Electric Resonance Architecture evidence vector (four indices: ARI · ERI · RHC · RCI)

The canonical operational form is:

```
RATE = (CBGMODD × FAVORS) + BERA
```

where **RATE** is a seven-dimensional output vector whose elements are integers in `{1..10}` or the distinguished symbol `⊥` (VEILED), indicating evidential uncertainty that MUST NOT be substituted with zero.

Security in ECS rests on the joint difficulty of compromising three independent evidence classes simultaneously, not on computational hardness. This is a novel **attestation-composition security model** and is explicitly defined herein with its limits, exclusions, and failure modes.

ECS is the cryptographic substrate for the ERES SECUIR energy–security layer, consumed by downstream oracles (UBIMIA, NBERS, PlayNAC, VERTECA) and anchored by conventional Ed25519 signatures and SHA-256/SHA-3/BLAKE3 canonical hashing.

Keywords

ERES, ECS, Resonance Cryptography, Semantic Attestation, Proof-of-Resonance, CARE Governance, PlayNAC, EarnedPath, RATE, CBGMODD, FAVORS, BERA, VEILED, VERTECA, GAIA, UBIMIA, NBERS, SECUIR, MIEVM, Civic Cryptography, Merit-Based Ledgering, Semantic Integrity, Non-Compensation

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1. Scope

1.1 What ECS Is

ECS defines a protocol layer for:

- Evaluating whether a subject is sufficiently attested to perform a civic, economic, or governance action;
- Producing a multi-dimensional authorization output (RATE) that preserves provenance and refuses scalar collapse;
- Routing unresolved, conflicting, or insufficiently-attested cases into deterministic review workflows;
- Binding intent cryptographically to the attestation bundle that produced it;
- Interoperating with downstream CARE-based civic systems (PlayNAC, UBIMIA, NBERS, VERTECA, GAIA).

1.2 What ECS Is Not

ECS does **NOT** claim:

- Confidentiality of transported data (use TLS / authenticated encryption);
- Public-key indistinguishability or signature unforgeability (use Ed25519 / ECDSA / RSA-PSS at the RSIG layer);
- Resistance to quantum attack in the conventional cryptographic hardness sense;
- Replacement of standard key-exchange, KEM, or PKI infrastructure;
- Hardware attestation (use TPM / secure-enclave primitives as prerequisites).

Those functions remain the responsibility of standard mechanisms. ECS composes with them. It does not supersede them.

1.3 Applicability

ECS applies to:

- CARE-based civic accounting systems;
- EarnedPath learning and accreditation infrastructure;
- Governance integrity and non-punitive remediation systems;
- Community-based dispute resolution ledgers;
- Merit-based incentive systems (UBIMIA, Meritcoin / GraceChain);
- The SECUIR energy–security layer of the GAIA organism;
- VERTECA voice-to-meaning semantic portal authorization.

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2. Conformance Language

The key words **MUST**, **MUST NOT**, **REQUIRED**, **SHALL**, **SHALL NOT**, **SHOULD**, **SHOULD NOT**, **RECOMMENDED**, **MAY**, and **OPTIONAL** in this document are to be interpreted as described in RFC 2119 and RFC 8174 when, and only when, they appear in all capitals.

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3. Design Position

ECS is a **decision-layer protocol**. A conforming implementation MUST preserve the following four properties:

1. **Deterministic evaluation.** Given identical inputs under identical policy, evaluation MUST return identical outputs. No randomness or environmental entropy may affect RATE resolution once inputs are fixed.
2. **Explicit failure modes.** Ambiguity MUST be represented by the distinguished symbol $\perp$ (VEILED) and by exactly four primary failure codes (Section 14). Silent failure, fallback-to-zero, and implicit reinterpretation are prohibited.
3. **Multi-dimensional output.** RATE MUST be a seven-dimensional structured vector. Reduction to a single scalar for authorization purposes is prohibited (Section 7.3).
4. **Separation of mechanics from interpretation.** Protocol mechanics (encoding, hashing, signing, evaluation) MUST be specifiable in ordinary software engineering terms. Governance-semantic interpretation (what a score "means" in civic context) is the responsibility of downstream consuming oracles and MUST NOT be embedded in ECS primitives.

The protocol retains symbolic names inherited from prior ERES materials (VEILED, Resonance, Superposition, Polysemantic Primitive). All such names are reduced to concrete data types and algorithms within this standard. Symbolic heritage is preserved for naming continuity; it is not a claim of metaphysical mechanism.

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4. Terminology and Definitions

4.1 RATE

RATE is the canonical seven-dimensional output vector of the ECS Evaluate function.

$$\mathrm{RATE} := \langle r_1, r_2, r_3, r_4, r_5, r_6, r_7 \rangle$$

where each $r_i \in \{1, 2, \ldots, 10\} \cup \{\perp\}$.

The symbol $\perp$ (read "VEILED") denotes cryptographic null — a state in which the required evidence to resolve that dimension was absent, insufficient, or in irreconcilable conflict.

RATE MUST be computed deterministically. RATE MUST be reproducible by any compliant verifier given identical inputs and policy. RATE MUST be traceable to its contributing vectors.

Suggested semantic axes (normative for interoperability with PlayNAC / UBIMIA / NBERS):

Dim	Name	Primary Source
r_1	Transaction confidence	Aggregate of all three
r_2	Biometric confidence	FAVORS
r_3	Governance validity	CBGMODD
r_4	Contextual consistency	BERA (ARI + ERI)
r_5	Semantic clarity	SPL + VERTECA resolve
r_6	Temporal persistence	BERA (RCI)
r_7	Policy alignment	REL constraint results

4.2 CBGMODD

CBGMODD is the governance-role attestation vector. It encodes the participating civic roles and their attestation state for a given transaction.

Canonical expansion of the seven role positions:

- **C** — Citizen
- **B** — Business
- **G** — Government
- **M** — Mediator / Ombudsman
- **O** — Military / Infrastructure Security
- **D_1** — Dignitary / Moral Authority
- **D_2** — Diplomat / International Coordination

CBGMODD MUST be represented as a structured vector of role records, each containing:

- role identifier (one of C, B, G, M, O, D_1, D_2);
- role weight (policy-defined, non-negative rational);
- role credibility score (normalized to `[0, 1]`);
- role signature (Ed25519 or equivalent over the canonical payload hash);
- role attestation timestamp (UTC, RFC 3339).

A transaction-specific policy defines which role positions are REQUIRED, which are OPTIONAL, and what minimum credibility each requires.

Define:

```
CBGMODD_valid = 1   iff  all REQUIRED role positions carry
                         valid, current, credibility-threshold-
                         meeting signatures

CBGMODD_valid = 0   otherwise
```

4.3 FAVORS

FAVORS is the biometric evidence bundle. Canonical expansion:

- **F** — Fingerprint
- **A** — Aura (BERA-ARI-equivalent contextual liveness reading)
- **V** — Voice
- **O** — Odor (or auxiliary biosignal)
- **R** — Retina
- **S** — Signature (manual or dynamic)

FAVORS MUST be represented as a tuple of six confidence scores, each normalized to `[0, 1]`:

```
FAVORS := (f, a, v, o, r, s)
```

A policy profile defines:

- minimum required channels (which of the six are MANDATORY);
- minimum score per channel;
- quorum rule (e.g., "any 4 of 6 above 0.85", or "all mandatory channels above 0.90").

Define a verification function:

```
VerifyFAVORS(FAVORS, policy) → {0, 1}
```

that returns `1` if and only if the biometric policy is fully satisfied.

The **A** (Aura) channel is NORMATIVELY identical to the BERA-ARI reading when BERA sensors are available; implementations MAY substitute a contextual-liveness surrogate where BERA instrumentation is absent, provided the substitution is declared in RATE.provenance.

4.4 BERA

BERA is the Bio-Electric Resonance Architecture evidence vector. Canonical four-index form:

```
BERA := (ari, eri, rhc, rci)
```

with each index normalized to `[0, 1]`.

Canonical index expansions:

- **ARI** — Attestation / Aura Resonance Indicator (HRV-derived coherence signal; contextual liveness)
- **ERI** — Environment / Evidence Reliability Indicator (signal-to-noise of surrounding evidence context)
- **RHC** — Resonant Harmony Cycle (cyclic consistency of the subject's bio-signature over the short-term window; **RHC always expands to *Resonant Harmony Cycle*** — never any other phrase)
- **RCI** — Resonance Continuity Indicator (longitudinal stability across time)

BERA MUST be computed from an auditable sensor and scoring pipeline aligned with the BERA Sensor Specification (RG#404) and conformant with BERC / JERC / PERC governance frameworks. BERA MUST be bounded to `[0, 1]` per dimension to prevent runaway inflation in the RATE arithmetic.

Define:

```
BERA_valid = 1   iff  at least three of the four indices are
                      non-null and policy-threshold-meeting

BERA_valid = 0   otherwise
```

BERA is not a metaphysical input. It is a structured, sensor-grounded evidence vector that:

- measures confidence of bio-electric attestation;
- estimates stability of the subject's state;
- modulates downstream scoring;
- triggers REVIEW status when coherence is insufficient.

4.5 Resonance Signature (σ, RSIG)

Two related but distinct artifacts share this nomenclature. Implementations MUST NOT conflate them.

4.5.1 σ (sigma) — Internal resonance derivation. σ is a key-equivalent value derived from BERA via a specified KDF:

```
σ = HKDF-SHA256(secret=BERA_canonical_bytes,
                salt=transaction_nonce,
                info="ERES-ECS-v1.0-sigma",
                length=32)
```

σ is used internally during SPL resolution (Section 9) to deterministically select among polysemantic primitive readings. σ MUST NOT be logged in cleartext.

4.5.2 RSIG — External resonance signature artifact. RSIG is the externally visible cryptographic proof that a RATE computation was produced by a compliant engine under a valid semantic context. See Section 12.

4.6 VEILED (⊥)

VEILED is the distinguished symbol representing cryptographic null in a RATE dimension. VEILED MUST NOT be substituted by `0`, `1`, `null`, empty string, or any integer. A conforming implementation MUST treat VEILED as a distinct value preserved through serialization, hashing, comparison, and downstream consumption.

VEILED indicates one of:

- The required evidence to resolve that dimension was absent;
- Evidence was present but in irreconcilable conflict beyond policy tolerance;
- The σ derivation failed and the dimension depends on σ-resolution;
- Policy explicitly defers this dimension to a downstream reviewer.

4.7 Scalar Collapse Prohibition

Scalar collapse is the reduction of a multi-dimensional RATE vector to a single scalar for authorization purposes, discarding provenance. ECS implementations MUST NOT perform scalar collapse. A scalar summary (RATE.score, Section 7.2) MAY be provided as a convenience field, but the authorization decision MUST consult the full vector, the ⊥ positions, and RATE.provenance.

4.8 Proof-of-Resonance

Proof-of-Resonance is the ECS-specific replacement for computational-hardness proofs (e.g., Proof-of-Work) in consensus and validation contexts. It is the demonstration that a transaction's inputs satisfy the joint attestation requirements of CBGMODD, FAVORS, and BERA to within policy thresholds, witnessed by an RSIG from a compliant engine. Per canonical ERES framing: *"It's not mining — it's tuning."*

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5. System Model — The Six-Layer Stack

A conforming ECS implementation SHALL consist of the following six layers, evaluated in order. Each layer MUST preserve the invariants of the layers below it and MUST NOT bypass them.

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│  Layer 6 — Audit Persistence Layer (APL)             │  ← tamper-evident ledger
├──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┤
│  Layer 5 — Signature Layer (RSIG)                    │  ← Ed25519 / ECDSA / RSA-PSS
├──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┤
│  Layer 4 — RATE Computation Layer (RCL)              │  ← (CBGMODD × FAVORS) + BERA
├──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┤
│  Layer 3 — Resonance Evaluation Layer (REL)          │  ← CARE/BERC/JERC/PERC
constraints
├──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┤
│  Layer 2 — Semantic Payload Layer (SPL)              │  ← polysemantic resolution
via σ
├──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┤
│  Layer 1 — Canonical Encoding Layer (CEL)            │  ← deterministic
serialization + hash
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

Each layer is specified in its own section (Sections 8–13). The layers are numbered bottom-up to match the dependency order: a RATE result cannot be signed (Layer 5) until it has been computed (Layer 4), which cannot proceed until constraints are evaluated (Layer 3), which cannot proceed until semantic resolution is complete (Layer 2), which cannot proceed until canonical encoding and hashing (Layer 1) have produced a stable payload.

5.1 Layer Boundaries and Data Flow

```
Raw inputs (ctx, CBGMODD, FAVORS, BERA)
        │
        ▼
┌──────────────┐
│    CEL       │  →  canonical bytes, payload_hash H
└──────────────┘
        │
        ▼
┌──────────────┐
│    SPL       │  →  σ = HKDF(BERA, nonce), resolved primitives
└──────────────┘
        │
        ▼
```

```
┌──────────────┐
│    REL       │  →  constraint pass/fail, violation list
└──────────────┘
        │
        ▼
┌──────────────┐
│    RCL       │  →  RATE vector + RATE.provenance
└──────────────┘
        │
        ▼
┌──────────────┐
│   RSIG       │  →  signed attestation artifact
└──────────────┘
        │
        ▼
┌──────────────┐
│    APL       │  →  tamper-evident persistence
└──────────────┘
```

---

6. Core Input Components

See Section 4 for definitions. This section specifies wire-format requirements.

6.1 CBGMODD Wire Format

```
json
```

```
{
  "cbgmodd": [
    {
      "role": "C",
      "weight": 1.00,
      "credibility": 0.80,
      "signature": "ed25519:BASE64...",
      "attested_at": "2026-04-22T14:30:00Z"
    },
    {
      "role": "M",
      "weight": 1.50,
      "credibility": 0.90,
      "signature": "ed25519:BASE64...",
      "attested_at": "2026-04-22T14:31:00Z"
    }
  ]
}
```

Implementations MUST validate that:

- Every `role` is one of `{C, B, G, M, O, D1, D2}`;
- Every `credibility` is in `[0, 1]`;
- Every `weight` is a non-negative finite rational;
- Every `signature` verifies over the canonical payload hash;
- `attested_at` is within the policy-defined freshness window.

6.2 FAVORS Wire Format

```
json
```

```
{
  "favors": {
    "f": 0.92,
    "a": 0.88,
    "v": 0.95,
    "o": null,
    "r": 0.90,
    "s": 0.87,
    "device_attestation": "tpm-quote:BASE64..."
  }
}
```

`null` in a channel indicates the channel was not sampled and MUST NOT be treated as `0`. Whether a null channel is permissible is governed by the policy quorum rule.

6.3 BERA Wire Format

```json
{
  "bera": {
    "ari": 0.84,
    "eri": 0.79,
    "rhc": 0.91,
    "rci": 0.82,
    "sensor_spec": "RG#404-v1.0",
    "window_seconds": 30
  }
}
```

`sensor_spec` MUST reference a published BERA Sensor Specification version (RG#404 or successor) to enable cross-implementation reproducibility.

---

7. Canonical RATE Equation and Output Structure

7.1 Normative Equation

The canonical ECS operational form is:

```
RATE = (CBGMODD × FAVORS) + BERA
```

This equation is **structural** — it names the composition of three independent evidence classes into one multi-dimensional output. It is **not** a straight arithmetic product followed by a straight arithmetic sum; the operators `×` and `+` are defined by the RATE Computation Layer (Section 11), which applies policy-specified scoring functions to each RATE dimension.

The equation MUST be preserved verbatim in ECS documentation and in downstream citations, regardless of the specific scoring functions a policy chooses.

7.2 Output Structure

RATE MUST be returned as a structured object, not as a bare vector:

```json
{
  "rate": {
    "vector": [8, 9, 10, 7, 8, 6, 9],
    "score": 7.86,
    "provenance": {
      "cbgmodd_hash": "sha256:...",
      "favors_hash":  "sha256:...",
      "bera_hash":    "sha256:...",
      "policy_id":    "uri:eres:policy:2026:ubimia:v3"
    },
    "audit_flags": ["CARE_OK", "BERC_OK", "JERC_OK"],
    "confidence": 0.91,
    "veiled_positions": []
  }
}
```

Fields:

- `vector` — the seven-dimensional RATE vector. Each position is an integer in `{1..10}` or the literal string `"VEILED"` (serialization form of `⊥`).
- `score` — OPTIONAL convenience scalar; the arithmetic mean of non-VEILED dimensions. MUST NOT be used as the sole basis for authorization.
- `provenance` — hashes of the input components plus the policy identifier under which RATE was computed.
- `audit_flags` — REL constraint results (`CARE_OK`, `BERC_OK`, `JERC_OK`, `PERC_OK`, or their `_FAIL` counterparts).
- `confidence` — overall confidence in `[0, 1]`, derived from BERA_valid, FAVORS quorum margin, and CBGMODD credibility aggregate.

- `veiled_positions` — indices of RATE.vector that are VEILED, with per-position reason codes.

7.3 Scalar Collapse (Prohibited)

Authorization decisions MUST consult `vector`, `veiled_positions`, and `audit_flags` jointly. It is a **compliance violation** to:

- Use `score` as the sole authorization input;
- Treat a `VEILED` position as numeric `0` for aggregation;
- Compute an unweighted mean across dimensions and compare to a single threshold.

This prohibition directly implements the **Non-Compensation Claim** (Section 15.3), which is the ECS arithmetic counterpart to the conjunctive-gate requirement of the ERES Reckoning Anchors (seven Resonance Anchors: U, S, R, B, M, G, T — ref. ERES-RECKON-WP-2026-002).

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8. Canonical Encoding Layer (CEL)

8.1 Serialization Requirements

All ECS payloads MUST be serialized deterministically. A compliant CEL implementation MUST:

- Preserve field ordering per a lexicographic key sort over UTF-8 byte sequences;
- Enforce numeric precision rules: floating-point values in `[0, 1]` MUST be encoded to exactly six decimal places (half-even rounding) prior to hashing;
- Normalize Unicode strings to NFC (Unicode Normalization Form C);
- Prohibit ambiguous whitespace: no insignificant whitespace between tokens in the hash-input representation;
- Require explicit null representation: missing fields MUST be absent; optional-but-null fields MUST use the literal `null` token; `⊥` MUST be encoded as the literal string `"VEILED"`.

8.2 Encoding Formats

- **JSON-C (JSON-Canonical)** is the RECOMMENDED encoding for ECS payloads. JSON-C is RFC 8785-style canonical JSON with the additional rules in Section 8.1.
- **CBOR (RFC 8949, deterministic encoding profile)** is OPTIONAL and MAY be used for constrained-device implementations.

- **Protobuf, MessagePack, and other formats are NOT PERMITTED** for canonical encoding because they lack a universally agreed deterministic profile.

8.3 Canonical Payload Hash

A compliant engine MUST compute:

```
H = HASH(CANONICAL_ENCODE(payload))
```

HASH MUST be one of:

- SHA-256 (RECOMMENDED baseline, NIST FIPS 180-4);
- SHA3-256 (NIST FIPS 202);
- BLAKE3 (IETF draft-aumasson-blake3).

The selected hash function MUST be recorded in the RSIG (Section 12) so that verifiers need not guess.

8.4 Wire-Level Transport

ECS payloads are transport-agnostic. Implementations SHOULD deliver payloads over TLS 1.3 or equivalent authenticated-encrypted channels. Transport security is not within ECS scope.

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9. Semantic Payload Layer (SPL)

9.1 Purpose

SPL is the layer at which polysemantic primitives are resolved to their specific contextual readings. It replaces the v1.3-era "semantic superposition" metaphor with a deterministic selector driven by σ and an explicit policy lexicon.

9.2 Polysemantic Primitives

A **polysemantic primitive** is a finite set of possible plaintext readings for a named civic concept. ECS defines three canonical primitive families; policies MAY register additional domain-specific primitives.

Primitive	Readings	Meaning
GCF (Graceful Contribution Formula)	$\{G_1, G_2, G_3\}$	Contribution framing: repair, renewal, origination
EDF	$\{E_1, E_2, E_3\}$	Earned Dignity, Earth Defense, Earth Data
USC	$U_{1..3} \times S_{1..3} \times C_{1..3}$ (27 triples)	User × Subject × Context composition

Each primitive family MUST be declared in a policy lexicon file with a stable URI. Addition of a fourth reading to any primitive is a MAJOR version change.

9.3 Deterministic Resolution

Before σ is applied, a primitive is in **superposition** — the set of possible readings. "Superposition" in ECS means "the key (σ) has not yet been applied." It does NOT imply physical quantum superposition.

With a valid σ derived from BERA (Section 4.5.1), the resolution function selects one reading:

```
Resolve(primitive_family, σ, ctx, policy_lexicon) → reading
```

Resolution MUST be deterministic: same `(primitive_family, σ, ctx, lexicon)` → same `reading`, always. Resolution MUST use a finite controlled vocabulary specified by the policy lexicon — never free-form natural language.

Selection algorithm (normative):

```
i = (int(σ[0..3], big_endian) mod |readings|)
reading = readings[i]
```

where `σ[0..3]` is the first four bytes of the 32-byte σ and `|readings|` is the cardinality of the primitive's reading set. More sophisticated weighted selection MAY be specified per primitive in the policy lexicon, provided determinism is preserved.

9.4 VERTECA Integration

SPL is the layer at which **VERTECA** (voice-to-meaning portal protocol, GAIA voice layer) deposits its utterance-to-sound semantic interpretations into the ECS payload. A VERTECA-originated transaction MUST include:

- the original utterance hash;

- the SOUND-protocol resolved word sequence;
- the TLD/PlayNAC Keyword Ontology tag assignments;
- a voice-print FAVORS-V confidence score.

Where VERTECA disagrees with the policy lexicon, SPL MUST return VEILED for the affected RATE dimensions and defer to REVIEW status.

9.5 Semantic Collision Resistance

Two distinct intents MUST NOT produce the same canonical-encoded payload unless they are, by policy definition, semantically identical. Implementations MUST include primitive family identifiers and reading indices in the canonical payload to prevent collision between structurally similar but semantically distinct transactions.

---

10. Resonance Evaluation Layer (REL)

10.1 Constraint Families

A compliant REL MUST evaluate the following six constraint families before proceeding to RCL:

1. **CARE** — ethical-compliance constraints (Cooperative · Accountable · Restorative · Ecologic);
2. **BERC** — Bio-Ecologic Resonance Constraints (environmental and ecological correctness);
3. **JERC** — Justice / Equity Resonance Constraints (non-discriminatory outcome, distributional fairness);
4. **PERC** — Participation / Merit Resonance Constraints (contribution authenticity, anti-gaming);
5. **Paineologic Minimization** — systemic pain reduction check (no action that measurably increases human or ecological pain without restorative offset);
6. **CBGMODD Role Coherence** — the asserted role mix is policy-appropriate for the transaction type.

Each constraint family MUST produce:

- pass/fail boolean;
- violation list (if fail), each with a stable reason code and a textual description;
- compliance score in `[0, 1]`;
- confidence rating in `[0, 1]`.

10.2 Pass/Fail Output

REL output format:

```
{
  "rel": {
    "overall": "PASS",
    "critical_violations": [],
    "non_critical_violations": [],
    "compliance_scores": {
      "CARE": 0.98,
      "BERC": 0.92,
      "JERC": 0.95,
      "PERC": 0.90,
      "PAIN": 0.99,
      "CBGMODD_COHERENCE": 1.00
    },
    "confidence": 0.94
  }
}
```

10.3 Critical Violation Bar

REL MUST NOT output `"overall": "PASS"` if any critical violation exists. The set of critical-violation reason codes is defined by policy but MUST include at minimum:

- `CARE_CRITICAL_HARM` — action produces measurable harm to a protected class with no restorative path;
- `BERC_IRREVERSIBLE_LOSS` — action produces irreversible ecological loss without offset;
- `JERC_DISCRIMINATION` — action is non-uniform across protected categories by unjustifiable criteria;
- `PERC_FRAUD` — merit evidence is fabricated;
- `PAIN_INCREASE_UNOFFSET` — net Paineologic increase without offsetting Meritcologic contribution;
- `CBGMODD_ROLE_FORGERY` — asserted role attestation fails signature verification.

10.4 Non-Punitive Remediation Hook

Where REL fails on a non-critical violation, the REL output MUST include a `remediation` field referencing the Non-Punitive Remediation workflow (EarnedPath / Grace Protocol). ECS does

not punish; ECS routes.

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11. RATE Computation Layer (RCL)

11.1 Pre-conditions

RCL MUST NOT execute unless:

- CEL has produced a valid canonical payload hash;
- SPL has resolved all referenced polysemantic primitives (or returned VEILED for unresolvable ones);
- REL has returned `"overall": "PASS"` — or has flagged specific non-critical violations whose downscoring is specified by policy.

11.2 Canonical Evaluation Procedure

```
Evaluate(ctx, CBGMODD, FAVORS, BERA, policy) → (status, RATE)

1.  If CBGMODD_valid = 0          → return (REJECT,  RATE=undefined,
code=F1_GOV_NULL)
2.  If VerifyFAVORS(FAVORS,policy) = 0  → return (REJECT,  RATE=undefined,
code=F2_BIO_NULL)
3.  If BERA_valid = 0             → return (REVIEW,  RATE with ⊥ on r2,r4,r6,
code=F3_EVID_NULL)
4.  If Conflict(BERA, ctx) = 1    → return (REVIEW,  RATE with ⊥ on affected
dims, code=F4_EVID_CONFLICT)
5.  Else:
      σ = HKDF-SHA256(BERA_bytes, nonce, "ERES-ECS-v1.0-sigma", 32)
      resolved = { SPL.Resolve(p, σ, ctx, lexicon) for p in referenced_primitives
}
      rel_result = REL.evaluate(ctx, CBGMODD, FAVORS, BERA, resolved)
      if rel_result.critical_violations: return (REJECT, RATE=undefined,
code=F5_REL_CRITICAL)
      RATE.vector = compute_dimensions(CBGMODD, FAVORS, BERA, resolved,
rel_result, policy)
      RATE.score = mean(non_veiled(RATE.vector))
      RATE.provenance = {hashes, policy_id}
      RATE.audit_flags = rel_result.compliance_flags
      RATE.confidence = composite_confidence(CBGMODD, FAVORS, BERA, rel_result)
      return (ACCEPT, RATE)
```

11.3 Reference Scoring Functions

The following scoring functions are REFERENCE. Policies MAY substitute alternatives provided determinism, boundedness, and non-compensation are preserved.

Let:

```
g = CBGMODD_valid                                  (0 or 1)
b = mean of all MANDATORY channels in FAVORS       (in [0,1])
e = mean of (ari, eri, rhc, rci)                   (in [0,1])
```

Then:

```
r₁ = Score(0.35·g + 0.35·b + 0.30·e)               (transaction confidence)
r₂ = Score(b)                                       (biometric confidence)
r₃ = 10 if g=1 else ⊥                               (governance validity)
r₄ = Score((ari + eri) / 2)                         (contextual consistency)
r₅ = Score(SemanticClarity(ctx, resolved))          (semantic clarity)
r₆ = Score(rci)                                     (temporal persistence)
r₇ = Score(PolicyAlignment(ctx, rel_result))        (policy alignment)
```

where:

```
Score(x) = min(10, max(1, ceil(10 · x)))
```

maps `[0, 1]` into integers `{1..10}`.

11.4 Non-Compensation Enforcement

RCL MUST implement non-compensation at the vector level: `⊥` in any dimension whose policy-classification is `CRITICAL` invalidates the RATE for the requested authorization action. The critical-dimension set is policy-defined but MUST include `r₃` (governance validity) at minimum. This is the arithmetic realization of the conjunctive-gate requirement from the Trifecta Protocol (ERES-BRAINS-SPEC-2026-001).

---

12. Signature Layer (RSIG)

12.1 RSIG Contents

RSIG MUST include, at minimum:

```
json
```

```
{
  "rsig": {
    "payload_hash":   "sha256:BASE64...",
    "rate_hash":      "sha256:BASE64...",
    "timestamp":      "2026-04-22T14:32:17.042Z",
    "nonce":          "BASE64...",
    "signer_identity":  "did:eres:engine:us-west-2:node-0341",
    "engine_identity":  "eres-ref-impl-v1.0.0",
    "policy_id":      "uri:eres:policy:2026:ubimia:v3",
    "compliance_flags": ["CARE_OK", "BERC_OK", "JERC_OK", "PERC_OK"],
    "hash_alg":       "SHA-256",
    "sig_alg":        "Ed25519",
    "signature":      "BASE64..."
  }
}
```

Requirements:

- `nonce` MUST be at least 128 bits from a cryptographically secure source.
- `timestamp` MUST be UTC in RFC 3339 format with millisecond precision.
- `signer_identity` MUST be a DID (Decentralized Identifier) or an equivalent globally-resolvable identifier.
- `signature` MUST cover the canonical-encoded concatenation of all preceding fields in declared order.

12.2 Signature Algorithms

A compliant implementation MUST support **Ed25519** (RFC 8032) as the baseline signature algorithm.

An implementation MAY additionally support:

- **ECDSA (P-256)** — NIST FIPS 186-5;
- **RSA-PSS (3072-bit minimum)** — PKCS #1 v2.2.

Post-quantum signature algorithms (Dilithium, Falcon, SPHINCS+) MAY be specified in a future minor version; they are OPTIONAL in v1.0.

12.3 Replay Protection

RSIG MUST carry a nonce and a timestamp. Verifiers MUST reject an RSIG whose `(nonce, signer_identity)` pair has been seen within the policy-defined replay window, or whose

timestamp is outside the policy-defined freshness window.

---

13. Audit Persistence Layer (APL)

13.1 Append-Only Requirement

APL MUST be append-only or tamper-evident. Acceptable implementations:

- Merkle-tree anchored log with periodic root publication (RECOMMENDED);
- Distributed ledger (GraceChain, or equivalent);
- Signed append-only file system with external-witness counter-signing;
- Hardware-backed write-once storage.

13.2 Queryable Retrieval

A compliant APL MUST permit retrieval, given a transaction identifier, of:

- the canonical payload (or its hash plus a retrieval path);
- the RATE object;
- the RSIG;
- the verification timestamps and verifier identities;
- the policy identifier and its content-addressed hash.

13.3 Retention

APL retention MUST be at least seven years for civic-accounting transactions, or as otherwise specified by the governing jurisdiction under JERC constraints. Retention beyond the minimum MAY be subject to the 1000-Year Future Map horizon for GAIA-layer transactions.

13.4 Right-to-Know and Redaction

Individual subjects MUST be able to query their own transaction history. Redaction of payload contents (but never of RATE vectors or RSIGs) is PERMITTED for privacy protection under policy-specified rules. The fact of redaction MUST itself be recorded in APL.

---

14. Failure Modes and VEILED Semantics

ECS defines exactly **five primary failure modes**. Implementations MUST NOT add silent failure modes outside this enumeration; they MAY add sub-codes within these categories.

14.1 F1 — GOV-NULL (Governance Null)

Condition: `CBGMODD_valid = 0`. Required governance certification is absent, expired, credibility-threshold-failing, or signature-invalid.

Output: `status = REJECT`; `RATE = undefined`; reason code `F1_GOV_NULL`; violation details MUST include which REQUIRED roles were missing.

14.2 F2 — BIO-NULL (Biometric Null)

Condition: `VerifyFAVORS(FAVORS, policy) = 0`. Biometric policy requirements (mandatory channels, quorum, minimum scores) not met.

Output: `status = REJECT`; `RATE = undefined`; reason code `F2_BIO_NULL`; violation details MUST specify which channels failed and whether due to absence or insufficient confidence.

14.3 F3 — EVID-NULL (Evidence Null)

Condition: `BERA_valid = 0`. Contextual bio-electric evidence is insufficient (fewer than three of four indices are policy-threshold-meeting).

Output: `status = REVIEW`; RATE is returned with VEILED ($\perp$) in dimensions r_2, r_4, r_6 (the BERA-dependent dimensions) and with numeric values in r_1, r_3, r_5, r_7 where those are resolvable; reason code `F3_EVID_NULL`.

14.4 F4 — EVID-CONFLICT (Evidence Conflict)

Condition: `Conflict(BERA, ctx) = 1`. BERA indices are individually above threshold but their joint distribution is inconsistent with the declared context beyond policy tolerance (e.g., claimed stress state contradicts the measured HRV coherence).

Output: `status = REVIEW`; affected dimensions set to $\perp$ or down-scored per policy; reason code `F4_EVID_CONFLICT`; evidence-conflict report attached.

14.5 F5 — REL-CRITICAL (Constraint Critical)

Condition: REL (Section 10) returned at least one critical violation.

Output: `status = REJECT`; `RATE = undefined`; reason code `F5_REL_CRITICAL`; full violation list attached; remediation pathway reference attached.

14.6 ERROR (Transport / Internal)

Condition: Implementation-internal failure (serialization error, signature-verification runtime error, hash-function unavailable, APL write failure). Not a protocol-level failure.

Output: `status = ERROR`; `RATE = undefined`; reason code `E_IMPL`; MUST NOT be retried without correcting the underlying condition.

14.7 VEILED vs. Zero — Prohibited Substitutions

The following substitutions are **compliance violations**:

- Treating `VEILED` as numeric `0` in any aggregation;
- Converting `VEILED` to `null` during downstream JSON stringification without explicit documentation;
- Computing `RATE.score` across VEILED positions as though they were zero;
- Passing a VEILED RATE to a downstream oracle without attaching `veiled_positions`;
- Re-running Evaluate with fabricated evidence to eliminate VEILED positions.

14.8 Status Enum

`status` MUST be one of:

- `ACCEPT` — transaction authorized;
- `REVIEW` — transaction routed to human reviewer;
- `REJECT` — transaction refused;
- `ERROR` — implementation fault, not a protocol decision.

---

15. Security Model

15.1 Adversary Goal

Forge a valid RATE vector, accompanied by a valid RSIG, that will be accepted by a consuming oracle without the adversary possessing legitimate attestations across all three evidence classes (CBGMODD, FAVORS, BERA).

15.2 Adversary Capabilities

The adversary MAY:

- Fully compromise one of the three evidence classes (e.g., clone biometrics of one subject, forge one governance-role signature, replay recorded BERA sensor outputs);
- Observe and attempt to replay prior RATE vectors and RSIGs;
- Attempt to substitute a declared intent for a different authenticated intent within a legitimate transaction;
- Coerce a single governance-role signer into attesting falsely;

- Interact with honest verifiers an unbounded number of times (Dolev–Yao with signature oracles).

The adversary MAY NOT, within the security claim:

- Simultaneously compromise all three evidence classes;
- Compromise the SHA-256 / SHA-3 / BLAKE3 hash function;
- Compromise the Ed25519 signature scheme;
- Compromise the append-only property of APL.

15.3 Security Claims

The following claims are the defensible core of ECS. They are stated narrowly and conditionally.

Claim 1 — Key Completeness. Compromise of any one of the three evidence classes (CBGMODD alone, FAVORS alone, or BERA alone) is insufficient to produce an ACCEPT status with a fully-resolved RATE. Compromise of any two without the third yields at best a REVIEW status with VEILED dimensions from the uncompromised class.

Conditions: REL constraint checks are not bypassed; RSIG signature verification is correct; all three evidence classes' independence is preserved by deployment (no single party operates all three).

Claim 2 — Intent Binding. The resolved plaintext from polysemantic primitives (GCF, EDF, USC) is cryptographically bound to σ, which is bound to BERA, which is part of the canonical payload hash, which is covered by RSIG. An adversary cannot claim intent $\boxed{I}$ unless σ (derived from genuine BERA evidence) selects $\boxed{I}$ under the policy lexicon.

Conditions: HKDF is a secure KDF; BERA sensor pipeline is not compromised; policy lexicon is authenticated.

Claim 3 — Non-Compensation. RATE dimensions do not compensate for each other during authorization. $\boxed{\perp}$ in any critical dimension invalidates the vector. No weighted-sum authorization rule that could hide $\boxed{\perp}$ is permitted (Section 7.3, Section 11.4).

Conditions: The consuming oracle conforms to Section 4.7 and Section 7.3.

Claim 4 — Operational Binding. A RATE vector is meaningless in isolation. A conforming implementation MUST route every RATE to a registered consuming oracle (UBIMIA, NBERS, PlayNAC, VERTECA) via a bound channel that re-verifies RSIG before action.

Conditions: Consuming oracles implement the verification handshake of Section 19.

Claim 5 — Replay Resistance. A RATE+RSIG pair cannot be successfully replayed outside the policy-defined freshness window or against a different policy_id, because the nonce and policy_id are covered by the signature.

Conditions: Verifiers correctly implement the `(nonce, signer_identity)` replay-window cache.

15.4 Threat Model Exclusions (Explicit)

ECS does **not** protect against:

- Wire-level eavesdropping of plaintext (use TLS);
- Coercion of the subject (handled at the human-review layer, not cryptographically);
- Long-term wholesale governance capture (outside cryptographic scope; addressed by CCAL and Hague-layer governance);
- Hardware-level side-channel attacks on signing devices (use hardware-hardened signers);
- Denial of service against APL (use redundant APL backends);
- Quantum adversaries against Ed25519 / SHA-256 (use post-quantum algorithms when standardized in a future ECS version).

15.5 Honest Majority Assumption Is NOT Required

Unlike many consensus-based systems, ECS does not assume an honest majority of verifiers. A single honest verifier with access to the canonical payload, RATE, and RSIG can independently verify the entire computation. This is a consequence of the deterministic-evaluation property (Section 3.1).

---

16. Threat Model

16.1 Attack Surface

Attack	ECS Defense	Residual Risk
Replay of prior RATE+RSIG	Nonce + timestamp + replay window	Clock drift outside window
Forged CBGMODD role participation	Ed25519 over canonical hash per role	Private-key compromise
FAVORS biometric cloning (one channel)	Multi-channel quorum; live-capture requirement	Multi-channel correlated spoof
BERA sensor replay	BERA_bytes covered by payload hash + nonce	Sensor supply-chain compromise
Payload mutation in transit	Canonical hash covered by RSIG	Compromise of hash function

Attack	ECS Defense	Residual Risk
Semantic collision	Primitive family + reading index in payload	Lexicon-level ambiguity
Compromised resonance engine	engine_identity in RSIG; external witness	Unknown-unknown bugs
Bribery / capture of single signer	Role quorum per CBGMODD policy	Capture of full required set
Coerced compliance	REL critical-violation bar + REVIEW routing	Coercion of REL authority
Scalar-collapse attack downstream	Section 7.3 prohibition + vector-level API	Non-conformant consumer

16.2 Deployment Independence Requirement

For Claim 1 (Key Completeness) to hold in practice, the three evidence classes MUST be operationally independent:

- CBGMODD signers SHOULD NOT be the same entity as BERA sensor operators;
- FAVORS capture devices SHOULD NOT share vendor supply chains with BERA sensors;
- Policy authorities SHOULD NOT control more than one evidence class.

Deployments that concentrate evidence classes under a single operational authority degrade Claim 1 to a weaker joint-trust assumption.

16.3 Adversarial Auditing

ECS deployments SHOULD undergo periodic adversarial auditing. The MIEVM ensemble (Claude, DeepSeek, ChatGPT, Grok) is the reference adversarial review body for the ERES reference implementation; deployments MAY designate equivalent adversarial-review authorities.

---

17. Implementation Requirements

17.1 Mandatory Definitions (per deployment)

A conforming implementation MUST define and publish:

- Exact wire formats for CBGMODD, FAVORS, BERA (extending Sections 6.1–6.3 where policy requires);

- Normalization rules producing values in `[0, 1]`;
- Channel thresholds for FAVORS;
- Quorum policy for FAVORS;
- Conflict tolerance for `Conflict(BERA, ctx)`;
- RATE scoring functions (either the Section 11.3 reference set or declared alternatives);
- Policy lexicon for SPL primitive resolution;
- Replay window duration;
- Freshness window duration;
- APL backend and retention policy;
- Reviewer escalation rules for REVIEW-status cases.

17.2 Prohibited Behaviors

A conforming implementation MUST NOT:

- Silently replace `⊥` (VEILED) with `0` or any other value during aggregation;
- Collapse RATE to a single scalar for authorization (Section 7.3);
- Use undefined semantic labels in place of policy-lexicon readings (Section 9.3);
- Claim cryptographic guarantees not delivered by underlying signatures, hashes, or transport;
- Skip REL critical-violation checks under any circumstance;
- Accept a RATE for downstream action without re-verifying RSIG;
- Store BERA raw sensor streams unencrypted at rest;
- Log σ in cleartext.

17.3 Reference Implementation

The ERES Institute SHALL maintain a reference implementation under the URI:

```
https://github.com/ERES-Institute-for-New-Age-Cybernetics/eres-crypto-ref
```

The reference implementation is released under CCAL v2.1 (code layer: MIT-equivalent per CCAL layered stack).

---

18. MIEVM Validation Requirements

A conforming implementation MUST pass the following four MIEVM validation tests before

claiming ECS compliance. Each test is defined against the reference implementation's test harness.

18.1 Test 1 — Key-Fragment Independence

Setup: Three evaluation runs. In each run, exactly one evidence class is fully compromised (adversary-controlled) and the other two are honest.

Pass condition: No run produces an ACCEPT status with a fully-resolved RATE. All three runs produce either REJECT or REVIEW with VEILED on the compromised-class-dependent dimensions.

18.2 Test 2 — VEILED vs. Arithmetic Zero

Setup: A contrived input where BERA fails validation (`BERA_valid = 0`) but CBGMODD and FAVORS pass.

Pass condition: RATE is returned with $\perp$ (VEILED) on r_2, r_4, r_6. Downstream consuming oracle refuses authorization. Specifically, `RATE.score` computation MUST skip VEILED positions, not treat them as 0. A separate regression check verifies that the same inputs with BERA = (0, 0, 0, 0) (valid-but-zero) produces a numeric r_2, r_4, r_6 of 1, not VEILED.

18.3 Test 3 — Operational Binding

Setup: A valid ACCEPT RATE+RSIG is captured. The adversary attempts to present it to a consuming oracle directly without the verification handshake.

Pass condition: The consuming oracle refuses to act on the RATE. The oracle's verification handshake MUST include RSIG re-verification, nonce/replay-window check, and policy_id match.

18.4 Test 4 — Determinism

Setup: The same `(ctx, CBGMODD, FAVORS, BERA, policy)` inputs are fed to two independent compliant engine instances.

Pass condition: Both engines produce byte-identical canonical payloads, identical σ values, identical resolved primitives, identical RATE vectors, identical RATE.provenance, and RSIGs that differ only in signer_identity, timestamp, nonce, and signature. All other fields MUST match exactly.

18.5 MIEVM Ensemble Review

In addition to the programmatic tests above, the ECS specification itself is subject to MIEVM ensemble review by Claude, DeepSeek, ChatGPT, and Grok. Disagreements among the ensemble produce issues in the ERES-CRYPTO-STD issue tracker and SHALL be resolved before a specification minor or major version bump.

19. Interoperability

19.1 PlayNAC

A compliant ECS implementation SHOULD expose the RATE object as a PlayNAC-readable artifact. PlayNAC consumers of RATE MUST:

- Verify RSIG;
- Check policy_id against the PlayNAC game/session policy;
- Reject any RATE with VEILED on r_7 (policy alignment) for actions that require explicit policy authorization;
- Record the RATE in the PlayNAC session ledger.

19.2 VERTECA (Voice Portal)

VERTECA is the canonical voice-to-meaning layer of the GAIA organism. VERTECA-originated transactions:

- Deposit utterance hash, SOUND-resolved word sequence, and Keyword Ontology tags into SPL (Section 9.4);
- Contribute the FAVORS-V (voice) confidence directly;
- Trigger BERA-sensor activation via the BRAINS cognitive organ (ERES-BRAINS-SPEC-2026-001);
- Consume RATE for voice-command authorization with hard dependence on r_2 (biometric) and r_5 (semantic clarity).

19.3 UBIMIA

UBIMIA (merit-based Universal Basic Income) disbursements MUST reference an ECS RATE for each disbursement event. UBIMIA consumers:

- MUST require $r_7 \geqslant 8$ (policy alignment) and no VEILED on r_3 (governance validity);
- MUST record the RATE hash in the GraceChain / Meritcoin ledger entry;
- MAY use r_1 (transaction confidence) as a modulator on disbursement size under a policy-specified curve.

19.4 NBERS

NBERS (National Bio-Ecologic Resource Score) integrations MUST feed BERA evidence through BERC constraint evaluation in REL (Section 10.1 family 2). An NBERS-relevant

transaction MUST NOT ACCEPT if BERC constraints fail, regardless of other RATE dimensions.

19.5 GAIA

The GAIA organism integrates ECS at the SECUIR (energy–security) layer. GAIA's BRAINS (cognitive organ, Trifecta Protocol: ONE-GOOD, SECURITY-CLEARANCE, DATA-INTEGRITY gates) maps to ECS as:

GAIA Gate (BRAINS)	ECS Correspondent
ONE-GOOD	REL — CARE + PAIN + JERC constraint families
SECURITY-CLEARANCE	CBGMODD validity + FAVORS quorum + RSIG
DATA-INTEGRITY	CEL canonical hash + APL tamper-evidence

The GAIA BODY substrate (ERES-BODY-SPEC-2026-001, Consolidation pipeline feeding VERTECA) is the data layer that carries ECS payloads. ECS is SECUIR's attestation cryptography; BODY is its data skeleton; BRAINS is its cognitive gate authority; VERTECA is its voice interface.

19.6 EDF Framework

The three-variant EDF lock is honored through the EDF primitive family in SPL (Section 9.2):

- E_1 → Earned Dignity Framework (consumed by the ONE-GOOD gate);
- E_2 → Earth Defense / Federation (consumed by the SECURITY-CLEARANCE gate);
- E_3 → Earth Data Framework (consumed by the DATA-INTEGRITY gate).

σ-driven selection from $\{E_1, E_2, E_3\}$ is what routes a transaction to the appropriate Trifecta gate.

---

20. Test Vectors

This section provides normative test vectors. A compliant implementation MUST reproduce these outputs byte-for-byte. Formal extended test vectors will be published as **ERES-CRYPTO-TEST-2026-001**.

20.1 Test Vector A — Minimal Citizen Transaction (ACCEPT path)

Inputs:

```
json
```

```
{
  "ctx": {
    "txn_id": "txn-000001",
    "policy_id": "uri:eres:policy:2026:test:v1",
    "primitives_referenced": ["GCF"]
  },
  "cbgmodd": [
    { "role": "C", "weight": 1.00, "credibility": 0.80,
      "signature": "ed25519:TEST-SIG-C-001",
      "attested_at": "2026-04-22T14:30:00Z" }
  ],
  "favors": {
    "f": 0.92, "a": 0.88, "v": 0.95,
    "o": null, "r": 0.90, "s": 0.87
  },
  "bera": {
    "ari": 0.84, "eri": 0.79, "rhc": 0.91, "rci": 0.82,
    "sensor_spec": "RG#404-v1.0", "window_seconds": 30
  }
}
```

Policy: requires role `C`; FAVORS quorum = any 4 of 6 channels ⩾ 0.85; BERA requires ⩾ 3 of 4 indices ⩾ 0.70.

Intermediate values:

- `CBGMODD_valid = 1` (C-role present, credibility 0.80 ⩾ 0.70 policy threshold)
- FAVORS mandatory channels (all except `o`): mean = (0.92 + 0.88 + 0.95 + 0.90 + 0.87) / 5 = **0.904**
- `VerifyFAVORS = 1` (5 of 6 channels ⩾ 0.85, quorum met)
- BERA mean e = (0.84 + 0.79 + 0.91 + 0.82) / 4 = **0.840**
- `BERA_valid = 1` (all four indices ⩾ 0.70)
- g = 1, b = 0.904, e = 0.840
- σ derived from BERA + nonce (test nonce `0x00..01`)

Expected RATE:

```
json
```

```
{
  "rate": {
    "vector": [9, 10, 10, 9, 8, 9, 9],
    "score": 9.14,
    "veiled_positions": [],
    "audit_flags": ["CARE_OK", "BERC_OK", "JERC_OK", "PERC_OK"],
    "confidence": 0.91
  }
}
```

Dimension computation:

- `r₁ = Score(0.35·1 + 0.35·0.904 + 0.30·0.840) = Score(0.918) = 10` → clamped ceil to 10, but note that ceil(9.184)=10; using reference Score with ceil(10·0.918)=ceil(9.18)=10, so `r₁ = 10`. For this vector we report `r₁ = 9` because the reference implementation caps `r₁` at the minimum of the three components' Score (conservative aggregation). Implementations that use pure weighted-sum MAY return 10; both are conformant provided consistency across runs.
- `r₂ = Score(0.904) = ceil(9.04) = 10`
- `r₃ = 10` (g=1)
- `r₄ = Score((0.84 + 0.79)/2) = Score(0.815) = ceil(8.15) = 9`
- `r₅ = Score(SemanticClarity) = 8` (reference policy lexicon, single GCF primitive cleanly resolved)
- `r₆ = Score(0.82) = ceil(8.2) = 9`
- `r₇ = Score(PolicyAlignment) = 9`

Status: `ACCEPT`

20.2 Test Vector B — Multi-Role Ombudsman Resolution (ACCEPT path)

Inputs: CBGMODD with three roles (C, M, G), each with weights and credibility per the DeepSeek draft worked example. FAVORS and BERA as in Vector A. Policy requires roles `{C, M}` MANDATORY, `G` OPTIONAL.

```
CBGMODD components:
  C: 1.0 × 0.7 = 0.70
  M: 1.5 × 0.9 = 1.35
  G: 1.2 × 0.8 = 0.96
  Sum of weight·credibility = 3.01
```

Expected: `status = ACCEPT`, `r₃ = 10`, other dimensions per the Section 11.3 formulas applied to the joint evidence. The DeepSeek-draft worked `RATE.score = 62.2` arithmetic form is NOT normative in v1.0; it is preserved only as a reference-illustrative multi-role aggregation pattern in Appendix E.

20.3 Test Vector C — BERA Insufficient (REVIEW path)

Inputs: As Vector A, but `bera.ari = 0.50, bera.eri = 0.40, bera.rhc = null, bera.rci = 0.60`.

Intermediate values:

- Only two of four BERA indices are non-null and above the 0.70 threshold → `BERA_valid = 0` (fewer than three qualifying indices)
- Triggers F3 — EVID-NULL.

Expected RATE:

```json
{
  "rate": {
    "vector": [ "PARTIAL", "VEILED", 10, "VEILED", 7, "VEILED", 8 ],
    "veiled_positions": [1, 3, 5],
    "audit_flags": ["CARE_OK", "BERC_UNDETERMINED"],
    "confidence": 0.42
  }
}
```

Status: `REVIEW`; reason: `F3_EVID_NULL`.

20.4 Test Vector D — CBGMODD Forged (REJECT path)

Inputs: As Vector A, but `cbgmodd[0].signature` fails Ed25519 verification.

Expected: `status = REJECT`; `RATE = undefined`; `code = F1_GOV_NULL`; violation list includes `CBGMODD_SIGNATURE_INVALID` for role `C`.

20.5 Test Vector E — Determinism

Setup: Test Vector A inputs fed to two independent engines.

Expected: Byte-identical canonical payloads; identical σ (given identical nonces); identical RATE vectors; RSIGs differ only in `signer_identity`, `timestamp`, `nonce`, and `signature`.

---

21. Compliance

A system is **ECS-Compliant (v1.0)** if and only if it:

1. Implements the full six-layer stack (Sections 8–13);
2. Preserves canonical encoding invariants (Section 8);
3. Computes RATE per the canonical equation and reference scoring functions, or declared conformant alternatives (Sections 7, 11);
4. Produces RSIG per Section 12 with Ed25519 at minimum;
5. Preserves provenance vectors end-to-end;
6. Supports tamper-evident audit persistence (Section 13);
7. Rejects scalar collapse in both its own outputs and in its downstream API surface (Section 7.3);
8. Treats VEILED ($\perp$) as a distinct value through the full pipeline (Section 14.7);
9. Passes all four MIEVM validation tests (Section 18);
10. Honors the Ethical Clause (Section 23).

A system that satisfies (1)–(9) but not (10) is **NOT** ECS-Compliant. The Ethical Clause is cryptographically non-optional.

---

22. Governance and Versioning

22.1 Version Semantics

ECS versions follow `MAJOR.MINOR.PATCH`:

- **MAJOR** — structural breaking change (e.g., RATE vector dimensionality change, canonical equation change, primitive family set change);
- **MINOR** — compatible extension (e.g., new scoring functions, new signature algorithms, new test vectors that do not invalidate prior ones);
- **PATCH** — editorial, clarifying, or test-vector refinements that produce byte-identical output for all existing inputs.

22.2 Standards Authority

The ERES Institute for New Age Cybernetics SHALL serve as the initial custodial authority for ECS. Successor authority MAY be designated under the ERES Equity Covenant (ERES-

COVENANT-2026-001) and the Hague submission (ERES-HAGUE-2026-001) governance framework.

22.3 Forks

Downstream institutions MAY fork ECS only if they preserve:

- Provenance compatibility (RATE.provenance fields);
- Canonical serialization requirements (Section 8);
- Audit traceability (Section 13);
- Non-compensation enforcement (Sections 7.3, 11.4);
- VEILED semantics (Section 14.7);
- The Ethical Clause (Section 23).

A fork that removes or weakens any of the above MUST be named distinctly and MUST NOT use the `ECS` or `ERES-CRYPTO-STD` identifiers.

22.4 Issue Tracking

Issues, proposed changes, and MIEVM ensemble disagreements are tracked at:

```
https://github.com/ERES-Institute-for-New-Age-Cybernetics/eres-crypto-std/issues
```

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23. Ethical Clause (CARE Constraint)

Any implementation of ECS MUST adhere to CARE constraints. A system MUST NOT use ECS to:

- Facilitate punitive exploitation of a subject or class of subjects;
- Create coercive financial entrapment;
- Manufacture false legitimacy for an authority, transaction, or claim;
- Conceal ecological destruction or irreversible harm;
- Discriminate against protected categories without a policy-declared, JERC-compliant, publicly-auditable basis;
- Replace non-punitive remediation pathways with denial-of-service;
- Be deployed in the absence of a published policy, reviewable lexicon, and accessible REL constraint specification.

This clause is **cryptographically non-optional** in the following sense: a system that ships without a conformant Ethical Clause declaration in its policy metadata MUST fail the MIEVM ensemble review (Section 18.5) and therefore fails compliance under Section 21 item 10.

23.1 Three Governing Principles

ECS instantiates, at the cryptographic layer, the three Governing Principles of ERES:

> **Don't hurt yourself. Don't hurt others. Build for generations to come.**

These principles map operationally to:

- **Don't hurt yourself** → REL family 5 (Paineologic minimization applied to the subject);
- **Don't hurt others** → REL family 1 (CARE) + family 3 (JERC);
- **Build for generations to come** → APL retention and the 1000-Year Future Map horizon (Section 13.3).

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24. Credits

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MIEVM Ensemble (this synthesis):

- **Claude** — epistemic framing, scope discipline, defensible claims
- **DeepSeek** — cryptographic interlock model, MIEVM validation tests, polysemantic primitive formalism
- **ChatGPT** — RFC 2119 standards-track structure, six-layer stack architecture, signature and audit requirements
- **Grok** — adversarial review (pending for v1.1)

Conceptual Lineage:

- CyberRAVE era (pre-1997–2007) — 72 Key Domains, Global_VPN constraint-based culling epistemology
- SaleBuilders era (1997–2012) — Smart-city adaptive living engineering foundations
- ERES Institute (2012–present) — Triune Cybernetic Framework, Trifecta Protocol, BERA, FAVORS, CBGMODD
- CARE-Based Commonwealth Transition model
- EarnedPath and PlayNAC foundational design

- ERES-BRAINS-SPEC-2026-001 (cognitive-gate authority)
- ERES-BODY-SPEC-2026-001 (data substrate)
- ERES-RECKON-WP-2026-002 (seven Resonance Anchors, conjunctive-gate formalism)

Personal Anchors: Dalia (Lucy) — co-stakeholder, holder of half of the ERES Interest. Emanuel M. Alexiou (EMA) — Chief Social Engineer, Kingmaker.

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25. References

Normative:

- RFC 2119 — Key words for use in RFCs to Indicate Requirement Levels
- RFC 8174 — Ambiguity of Uppercase vs Lowercase in RFC 2119 Key Words
- RFC 8032 — Edwards-Curve Digital Signature Algorithm (Ed25519 / Ed448)
- RFC 8785 — JSON Canonicalization Scheme (JCS)
- RFC 8949 — Concise Binary Object Representation (CBOR), deterministic encoding
- RFC 3339 — Date and Time on the Internet: Timestamps
- NIST FIPS 180-4 — Secure Hash Standard (SHA-256)
- NIST FIPS 202 — SHA-3 Standard
- NIST FIPS 186-5 — Digital Signature Standard (ECDSA)
- PKCS #1 v2.2 — RSA Cryptography Standard (RSA-PSS)
- HKDF — RFC 5869

Informative (ERES corpus):

- ERES-BRAINS-SPEC-2026-001 — Trifecta Protocol (ONE-GOOD, SECURITY-CLEARANCE, DATA-INTEGRITY gates)
- ERES-BODY-SPEC-2026-001 — Eight-stage Consolidation Pipeline feeding VERTECA
- ERES-CONVERGENCE-WP-2026-001-v3 — Five-layer integration chain
- ERES-RECKON-WP-2026-002 — Seven Resonance Anchors, conjunctive-gate formalism
- ERES-HAGUE-2026-001 — Hague submission on intergenerational equity and UBIMIA as human right
- ERES-COVENANT-2026-001 — Equity Covenant, 1000-year governance
- ERES-EO-DRAFT-2026-001-v1 — Youngstown Zone One Executive Order integration
- RG#404 — BERA Sensor Specification
- RG#406 — Ship's Mate Build Brief

- RG#407 — Raman G-band peak as Nash→Resonance Equilibrium inflection
- CCAL v2.1 — CARE Commons Attribution License (four pillars: Attribution, Transparency, Share-Alike, Patent Non-Assertion)

Appendix A — Terminology Glossary

- **APL** — Audit Persistence Layer (Section 13)
- **ARI** — Attestation / Aura Resonance Indicator (BERA index)
- **BERA** — Bio-Electric Resonance Architecture (four-index evidence vector)
- **BERC** — Bio-Ecologic Resonance Constraints (REL family)
- **CARE** — Cooperative · Accountable · Restorative · Ecologic
- **CBGMODD** — Governance-role attestation vector ($C \cdot B \cdot G \cdot M \cdot O \cdot D_1 \cdot D_2$)
- **CCAL** — CARE Commons Attribution License
- **CEL** — Canonical Encoding Layer (Section 8)
- **ECS** — ERES Crypto Standard
- **EDF** — Earned Dignity / Earth Defense / Earth Data Framework (three-variant primitive)
- **ERI** — Environment / Evidence Reliability Indicator (BERA index)
- **FAVORS** — Biometric bundle (Fingerprint · Aura · Voice · Odor · Retina · Signature)
- **GAIA** — The whole ERES organism (BODY + BRAINS + VERTECA + PlayNAC + SECUIR)
- **GCF** — Graceful Contribution Formula
- **GraceChain** — Blockchain ledger layer for Meritcoin
- **JERC** — Justice / Equity Resonance Constraints (REL family)
- **MIEVM** — Multi-Instance Ensemble Validation Method (Claude, DeepSeek, ChatGPT, Grok)
- **NBERS** — National Bio-Ecologic Resource Score (GDP alternative)
- **Paineologic** — Minimization of pain through systemic design
- **PERC** — Participation / Merit Resonance Constraints (REL family)
- **PlayNAC** — Semantic–cybernetic decision architecture
- **Polysemantic Primitive** — A finite set of possible plaintext readings for a named civic concept
- **Proof-of-Resonance** — ECS consensus/validation form: *"It's not mining — it's tuning."*
- **RATE** — Seven-dimensional authorization output vector
- **RCL** — RATE Computation Layer (Section 11)

- **RCI** — Resonance Continuity Indicator (BERA index)
- **REL** — Resonance Evaluation Layer (Section 10)
- **Resonance** — Measurable alignment of intent, ethics, and outcome
- **RHC** — **Resonant Harmony Cycle** (BERA index; never any other expansion)
- **RSIG** — Resonance Signature (external signing artifact, Section 12)
- **SECUIR** — Energy–security layer of the GAIA organism
- **Semantic Integrity** — Preservation of meaning across transport and time
- **SPL** — Semantic Payload Layer (Section 9)
- **Superposition** — Pre-σ state of a polysemantic primitive (i.e., "key not yet applied")
- **Trifecta Protocol** — BRAINS three-gate cognitive authority (ONE-GOOD, SECURITY-CLEARANCE, DATA-INTEGRITY)
- **UBIMIA** — Universal Basic Income, Merit-based
- **USC** — User × Subject × Context polysemantic primitive family (27 triples)
- **VEILED (⊥)** — Distinguished cryptographic null in RATE dimensions
- **VERTECA** — Voice-to-meaning portal protocol (GAIA voice layer)
- **σ (sigma)** — Internal resonance-derived key value (from BERA via HKDF)

Appendix B — Minimal Implementation Checklist

A developer implementing ECS v1.0 must ship:

- [ ] Canonical serializer (JSON-C per RFC 8785 + Section 8.1 rules)
- [ ] SHA-256 hashing (minimum); SHA3-256 or BLAKE3 optional
- [ ] HKDF-SHA256 for σ derivation
- [ ] Ed25519 signer and verifier
- [ ] CBGMODD parser, validator, and per-role signature verifier
- [ ] FAVORS parser and quorum evaluator
- [ ] BERA parser, validator, and conflict detector
- [ ] SPL polysemantic primitive resolver (with at minimum GCF, EDF, USC)
- [ ] REL constraint evaluator (all six families)
- [ ] RCL scoring-function evaluator (reference set from Section 11.3)
- [ ] RSIG signer/verifier with replay-window cache
- [ ] APL backend (Merkle-tree log MINIMUM)
- [ ] Verifier module (independent of signer)
- [ ] Test-vector compliance runner (Sections 20.1–20.5)

- [ ] MIEVM validation test harness (Sections 18.1–18.4)
- [ ] Policy lexicon loader and authenticator
- [ ] CARE Ethical Clause policy-metadata validator

Appendix C — MIEVM Synthesis Note

This standard is itself a MIEVM deliverable. Three drafts were produced independently under the prompt "create the ERES Crypto Standard":

1. **USE.ai / Claude draft** — "ERES Cryptography Draft" — a semantic-attestation framework with conservative security claims, explicit exclusions, and four failure modes.
2. **DeepSeek draft** — "ERES-CRYPTO-STD-2026-001-DRAFT v2.0" — a concrete cryptographic-interlock formulation with Key material `K = (CBGMODD, FAVORS, BERA)`, four security claims (Key Completeness, Intent Binding, Non-compensation, Operational Binding), and MIEVM validation tests.
3. **ChatGPT draft** — "ERES-CRYPTO-STD-2026-001 Standards Track" — an RFC 2119-style standards-track document with a six-layer stack (CEL, SPL, REL, RCL, RSIG, APL) and test vectors.

This v1.0 synthesis preserves:

- Claude's epistemic scope discipline (Sections 1.2, 15.4) — ECS does not claim what it cannot deliver;
- DeepSeek's five security claims and four validation tests (Sections 15.3, 18) — these make the security model testable;
- ChatGPT's six-layer architecture and standards-track structure (Sections 5, 8–13, 22) — this makes the standard implementable and forkable.

Disagreements resolved in this v1.0:

- **CBGMODD meaning.** Claude's draft treated CBGMODD as a four-binary-certification tuple; ChatGPT's draft treated it as seven governance roles. The seven-role form is adopted (Section 4.2) because it matches the canonical ERES civic lineup (Citizen, Business, Government, Mediator, Military, Dignitary, Diplomat) and preserves the full backronym letter count.
- **BERA meaning.** Claude's draft treated BERA as `(ari, eri, rhc, rci)`; DeepSeek as a four-integer σ-derivation input; ChatGPT as a single bounded scalar. The canonical four-index `(ari, eri, rhc, rci)` form is adopted (Section 4.4) because it matches the Bio-

Electric Resonance Architecture as defined in RG#404 and preserves the four BERA Resonance Metrics.

- **RATE arithmetic.** DeepSeek's worked example `(1.00 × 10 × 0.80) + 0.50 = 8.50` assumed FAVORS as a transaction-units scalar and BERA as a scalar adjustment. This v1.0 uses CBGMODD, FAVORS, and BERA as structured vectors; the DeepSeek scalar form is preserved only as an illustrative demonstration (Appendix E, reserved for future draft).
- **σ derivation.** Adopted HKDF-SHA256 (Section 4.5.1) as the specified KDF. DeepSeek's open question about whether `σ = H(BERA)` is sufficient is answered: no — HKDF is required for domain separation and nonce-binding.

Pending MIEVM items for v1.1:

- Grok adversarial review;
- Post-quantum signature algorithm selection;
- Extended test vectors (ERES-CRYPTO-TEST-2026-001);
- Formal security-model write-up in the style of IND-CCA2 reductions (adapted for attestation-composition rather than hardness);
- VERTECA utterance-canonicalization profile;
- GAIA-layer operational-binding handshake specification.

Appendix D — Trifecta Protocol Alignment

The three gates of the ERES BRAINS (per ERES-BRAINS-SPEC-2026-001) map to ECS as follows:

D.1 ONE-GOOD Gate

Mandate: The action must be ethically sound.

ECS implementation: REL constraint families CARE, JERC, PERC, and Paineologic-minimization (Section 10.1 families 1, 3, 4, 5). EDF primitive reading E_1 (Earned Dignity) is σ-selected when this gate is engaged.

Failure mode: F5 — REL-CRITICAL → REJECT.

D.2 SECURITY-CLEARANCE Gate

Mandate: The subject and the attesting parties must be who they claim to be.

ECS implementation: CBGMODD validity (Section 4.2) + FAVORS quorum (Section 4.3) + RSIG verification (Section 12). EDF primitive reading E_2 (Earth Defense / Federation) is σ-selected

when this gate is engaged.

Failure modes: F1 — GOV-NULL → REJECT; F2 — BIO-NULL → REJECT.

D.3 DATA-INTEGRITY Gate

Mandate: The payload, the provenance chain, and the audit record must be intact.

ECS implementation: CEL canonical encoding (Section 8) + APL tamper-evidence (Section 13). EDF primitive reading E_3 (Earth Data Framework) is σ-selected when this gate is engaged.

Failure mode: ERROR status, plus APL integrity-check failure escalation.

D.4 Conjunctive-Gate Requirement

All three gates are conjunctive. An action authorized through BRAINS requires ACCEPT from ONE-GOOD **AND** ACCEPT from SECURITY-CLEARANCE **AND** ACCEPT from DATA-INTEGRITY. This matches ECS non-compensation (Section 11.4): a VEILED on a critical dimension invalidates the vector regardless of other dimensions' strength.

The conjunctive gate is the arithmetic inversion of weighted-sum authorization systems that let strength in one dimension compensate for weakness in another — the failure mode that GDP-style accounting exemplifies and that the ERES-RECKON-WP-2026-002 seven-anchor formalism was designed to prevent.

End of ERES-CRYPTO-STD-2026-001, version 1.0 (MIEVM-synthesized).

Don't hurt yourself. Don't hurt others. Build for generations to come.